

Window: Fri 21 Aug 2026 full session (from Thu 20 Aug 20:15 ET cutoff) through weekend Sat 22 – Sun 23 Aug 2026, research cutoff approx. Sun 23 Aug 20:10 ET / Mon 24 Aug 00:10 UTC.

Assumptions & corrections box. Scheduler: single clean fire at 2026-08-24T00:08:52Z, ~9 minutes after the intended 00:00 UTC slot — no duplicate, no gap, confirms the trigger remains healthy. **Editorial correction (the most consequential finding of this edition):** Jerome Powell is no longer Fed Chair — Kevin Warsh was sworn in 22 May 2026^[4] — and the 2026 Jackson Hole Symposium runs Thu–Sat 27–29 Aug, with Warsh's first keynote as Chair on Friday 28 Aug, not last week^{[5][6]}. This briefing therefore drops any Jackson-Hole framing for Friday's session (that catalyst is still ahead — see Section 6) and attributes Friday's price action to its actual drivers: a strong flash PMI print and Ross Stores' earnings beat. **Data correction carried from edition 5:** Thursday 20 Aug's VIX close, logged last time as an unconfirmed single-sourced approx. 15.98, is now confirmed by two independent sources at 16.01 (+7.5%)^{[2][46]}.

60-SECOND READ

- 1 The Fed-speech story never happened.** Friday's rally had nothing to do with Jackson Hole — that event is Aug 27–29, and Kevin Warsh, not Powell, is Chair. The real Friday catalyst was a stronger-than-expected US flash composite PMI (56.0, fastest since April 2022) plus Ross Stores' earnings beat^{[1][17]}.
- 2 Equities trimmed a shaky week's losses Friday** — S&P +0.43% to 7,674.37, Dow +0.98%, Nasdaq +0.43%, Russell +0.85% — but the week itself stayed net negative (S&P –1.44% wk) with Tech and Industrials the weakest sectors, both now facing a fresh weekend headwind^{[1][7]}.
- 3 Rates markets are pricing hike risk into the Sept 16 FOMC, not cut risk** — Polymarket puts it 69% hold / 31% hike / approx. 1% cut, after July's meeting drew three dissents in favor of a hike. Long yields stayed elevated even as Treasury doubled its bond-buyback program^{[24][25]}.
- 4 US–Canada trade talks collapsed over the weekend.** 50% US tariffs on approx. \$20bn of Canadian goods took effect 12:01am ET Saturday; Canada plans dollar-for-dollar retaliation from 8 Sept on steel, dairy, appliances, machinery, paper and electronics — a fresh hit to already-underperforming Materials and Industrials^{[20][21]}.
- 5 A heavy five-session catalyst stack starts today:** a Bessent Iran-sanctions press conference (today), NVDA earnings Wed 26 Aug (cons. EPS \$2.09 / rev \$92.07bn), Marvell Thu 27 Aug, and Fed Chair Warsh's Jackson Hole debut Fri 28 Aug^{[15][22]}.

1. MARKET RECAP

S&P 500 7,674.37 ▲ +0.43%	Dow Jones 53,277.01 ▲ +0.98%	Nasdaq Comp 26,180.46 ▲ +0.43%	Russell 2000 3,017.87 ▲ +0.85%	VIX 15.13 ▼ –5.50%
10Y Treasury approx. 4.47% ▲ +approx. 3bp	DXY approx. 98.7 ▼ approx. –1% wk	WTI crude approx. \$86.8 ● approx. flat	Gold (spot) \$4,602.99 ▲ +1.86%	Bitcoin approx. \$77,119 ▲ approx. +7%

US equities closed higher Friday, snapping back from a shaky week, on a stronger-than-expected flash PMI print and a Ross Stores earnings beat — AP's own explanatory copy cites those two drivers plus rising oil prices, with no Fed-speech catalyst in the mix^[1]. All four major indices closed at fresh weekly lows relative to Monday but posted their first daily gain in the window; Friday was also the August monthly options expiration, discussed in Section 5.

2. EQUITIES AND EARNINGS

Index closes for Friday 21 Aug, cross-verified against two independent AP-syndicated wraps: S&P 500 7,674.37 (+0.43%), Dow 53,277.01 (+0.98%), Nasdaq Composite 26,180.46 (+0.43%), Russell 2000 3,017.87 (+0.85%)^[1]. The week itself stayed net negative — S&P –1.44%, Nasdaq –2.17%, Russell –1.73% week-over-week per LPL Research's Friday close-out, with Information Technology (–3.35%) and Industrials (–3.31%) the weakest S&P sectors of the week and Health Care (+4.32%) and Energy (+2.58%) the strongest (week-ending cut; a same-day sector table remains unobtainable at the close, consistent with prior editions)^[7]:

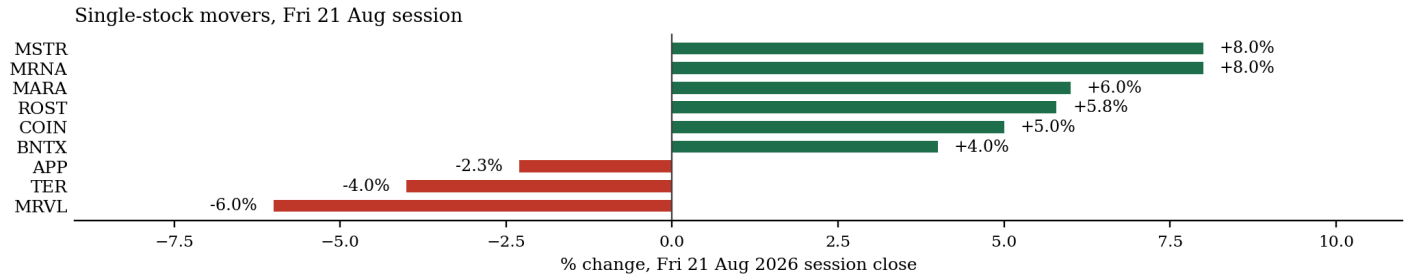
Health Care	+4.32%	Consumer Staples	–1.20%
Energy	+2.58%	Financials	–1.23%
Materials	+2.28%	Communication Svcs	–1.47%
Consumer Discretionary	–0.24%	Utilities	–3.04%
Real Estate	–0.56%	Industrials	–3.31%
		Information Technology	–3.35%

Week ending Friday 21 Aug 2026, S&P 500 GICS sectors^[7]

Ross Stores (ROST) led Friday's positive movers, +5.79% after a Q2 beat and raised full-year guidance — though 10% comp growth was guided down to 4–5% by Q4, and roughly \$0.60/share of the EPS beat was a one-time IEEPA tariff-refund benefit^[8]. The mRNA trade whipsawed for a third straight session with no fresh clinical news: Moderna (MRNA) +8% to \$143.79, BioNTech (BNTX) +4% to \$114.97, a sentiment bounce following the prior two sessions' spike-and-giveback already covered in the last edition^[9]. Bitcoin broke out of its 2026 range to a high near \$79,346 before settling around \$77,119, lifting Strategy Inc (MSTR) +8% to \$120.86, MARA Holdings +6% to \$11.81, and Coinbase (COIN) +5% to \$180.54; Robinhood was reported up double-digits intraday but a confirmed close could not be verified^[10]. On the downside: Marvell Technology (MRVL) approx. –6% into its own 27 Aug print (cons. EPS \$0.93)^[16], Teradyne (TER) approx. –4% on a Baird downgrade to Neutral, and AppLovin (APP) approx. –2.3% on a Piper Sandler

price-target cut (these three single-sourced)^[11]. Nvidia (NVDA) separately denied an Information report of a China-tailored chip launch; the stock is the week's dominant catalyst into its Wed 26 Aug print (cons. EPS \$2.09, revenue \$92.07bn, range \$90.30–96.66bn)^[15].

Two causes flagged unresolved in the prior edition are now confirmed. Boeing's Thursday decline reflected a wider-than-expected quarterly loss, fresh FAA 737 MAX inspection directives, and Sell downgrades from both Citigroup and Goldman Sachs^[12]. Dick's Sporting Goods' Thursday drop was pre-earnings de-risking — World Cup marketing spend, House of Sport pre-opening costs, and Foot Locker integration costs — ahead of its Tue 25 Aug print^{[13][14]}.



3. MACRO, POLICY AND RATES

Friday's scheduled data point was the S&P Global flash PMI: composite 56.0 (vs. 54.5 in July), the fastest pace since April 2022, with services surging to 56.8 (cons. 54.0) even as manufacturing slipped to 53.2 (cons. 53.9) on fading safety-stock building and tariff-linked supply delays^[17]. Treasury yields rose on the beat — 2Y +5bp to approx. 4.24%, 10Y +approx. 3bp to approx. 4.47%, 30Y +approx. 2.5bp to approx. 5.28% (secondary-market levels; Treasury's own par-yield curve had not posted by cutoff) — even as the buyback story that dominated Wed–Thu kept fading: Treasury Secretary Bessent doubled long-end debt buybacks and said the operation "could be more than \$4 billion," but the 30-year stayed near a two-decade high after only briefly rallying^{[18][26][27]}.

Fed H.4.1 for the week ended 19 Aug posted on schedule: reserve balances eased to approx. \$2.935tn (from approx. \$2.94tn), TGA to approx. \$953.6bn, ON RRP up to approx. \$373.7bn, and total assets down to approx. \$6.746tn^[19]. The Sept 16 FOMC is now a hold-vs-hike debate, not hold-vs-cut: July's meeting held the funds rate at 3.50–3.75% on a 9–3 vote, with regional presidents Hammack, Kashkari and Logan all dissenting in favor of a hike^[24]; Polymarket pricing as of 23 Aug puts September odds at 69% hold, 31% hike, approx. 1% cut — a genuine shift from the cut-focused pricing seen earlier this year^[25].

The US–Canada trade relationship broke down over the weekend: talks collapsed Friday night, and 50% US tariffs on approx. \$20bn of Canadian goods (steel, dairy, lumber, autos, alcohol) took effect 12:01am ET Saturday^[20]. PM Mark Carney called Canada "at war" commercially with the US and pledged dollar-for-dollar retaliation from 8 Sept on steel, dairy, appliances, agricultural machinery, paper and electronics; the two sides gave conflicting accounts of who introduced new terms late in the talks^[21]. Separately, Treasury Secretary Bessent's promised "greatest coordinated economic isolation" package against Iran had not been detailed as of the weekend cutoff; he is expected to hold a press conference on it today, Monday 24 Aug^{[22][23]}.

4. COMMODITIES AND FX

Oil firmed on continued Strait of Hormuz disruption — only approx. 7 vessels transited Friday, roughly 5% of the approx. 130/day pre-war norm — with WTI in the approx. \$86–87/bbl range and Brent around approx. \$94/bbl; no exchange-confirmed settlement print was obtainable, only vendor closes^[28]^[29]. Iraq was granted an exemption to move its own tankers through Hormuz over the weekend, a modest de-escalation signal into Monday^[30]. Natural gas rose approx. 1.5% to approx. \$2.77/MMBtu; EIA's week-ended-14-Aug storage report showed a smaller-than-average +16 Bcf build (vs. 19 Bcf a year ago, 29 Bcf 5-yr avg.), leaving storage at 3,169 Bcf^[31].

Gold extended its rally to a third straight weekly gain, spot near \$4,602.99/oz (+1.86%) in Kitco's Friday evening report, on dollar softness and fading rate-conviction — not, as the assignment brief assumed, on any Jackson Hole remarks, which have not yet been delivered^[32]. Silver rose a more modest approx. 1.3% to approx. \$68.97 in the same report^[32]. Copper pulled back to approx. \$6.48/lb (LME) after setting a fresh record of approx. \$6.74/lb on Mon 17 Aug — a later, higher print than the 12 Aug record (\$6.7140) carried in prior editions — with LME inventories surging past one million tonnes^[33]. Platinum firmed approx. 1.1% to approx. \$1,846.29 (single-sourced)^[34].

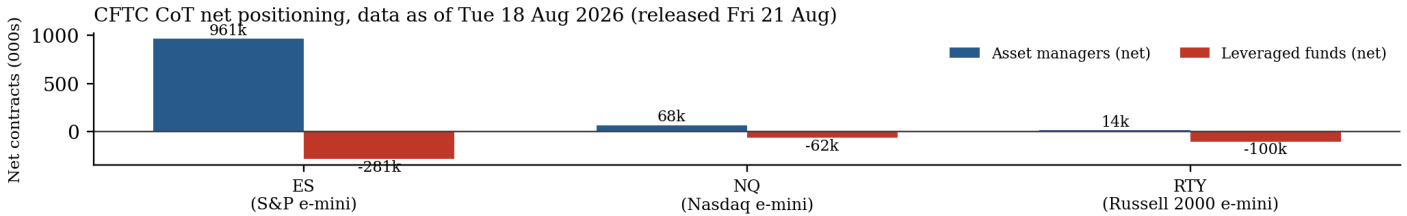
The dollar index eased to approx. 98.7, down approx. 1% on the week, again on fading hike-vs-hold conviction rather than any Fed speech^[35]. EUR/USD reached a three-month high near 1.1697 on ECB hike-bet repricing^[36]; USD/JPY traded in the low 159s, with swaps pricing approx. 80% odds of a September BoJ hike on hot inflation data — a genuine hawkish-BoJ story, not simple intervention chatter^[37]. GBP/USD touched a six-month high of 1.3675 on US bond-market concerns before settling near 1.3645^[38]. USD/CAD stood at 1.3945 ahead of the tariff deadline; no confirmed post-deadline reaction level was available by cutoff, so expect volatility at Monday's open^[39]. USD/MXN closed the week at 16.90 (Banxico), the peso firming approx. 0.7% on the week^[40].

WTI crude	approx. \$86–87/bbl	Brent crude	approx. \$94/bbl
Natural gas	approx. \$2.77/MMBtu (+1.5%)	Gold (spot)	\$4,602.99 (+1.86%)
Silver (spot)	approx. \$68.97 (+1.3%)	Copper (LME)	approx. \$6.48/lb
Platinum	approx. \$1,846.29 (+1.1%)	DXY	approx. 98.7 (–1% wk)
EUR/USD	1.1697 (3-mo high)	USD/JPY	approx. 159.0 (low 159s)
GBP/USD	1.3675 high / 1.3645 close	USD/CAD	1.3945 (pre-tariff)
USD/MXN	16.90 (+0.7% wk)		

5. DERIVATIVES, VOLATILITY AND POSITIONING

VIX fell approx. 5.5% to 15.13 Friday (VIX3M 18.50, ratio approx. 0.818 — firm contango), confirmed across four independent sources; Thursday's close is now confirmed at 16.01 (+7.5%), correcting the approx. 15.98 single-sourced estimate carried in the prior edition [\[2\]](#)[\[3\]](#)[\[46\]](#). VVIX eased to approx. 86.27 (single-sourced). Friday was also August's monthly options expiration, with approx. \$3tn of notional expiring; no post-event volume or gamma retrospective was locatable, but the day's price/vol action — VIX down, S&P up — reads as an orderly expiration rather than the "gamma cliff" some pre-event commentary had flagged [\[45\]](#).

CFTC's Commitment of Traders report (data as of Tue 18 Aug, released Fri 21 Aug — a standard 3–4 day lag) showed asset managers extending already-large net longs in S&P e-minis to +960,566 contracts and in Nasdaq e-minis to +68,332, while leveraged funds covered a meaningful chunk of their Nasdaq short (to –61,771, from –89,125 the prior week) and added modestly to Russell 2000 shorts (–99,786) [\[41\]](#):



NVDA options are pricing an approx. 7.0% implied move (approx. \$15.74 on a \$225.30 reference) into the 26 Aug print, essentially unchanged week-over-week; a second source's 5.27% read carried an internal date inconsistency and is weighted lower [\[42\]](#). Funding stayed unremarkable: ON RRP award rate held at 3.50% with take-up easing to approx. \$0.200bn from approx. \$0.225bn Thursday; SOFR's most recent published print was 3.63% (Wed 19–Thu 20 Aug window), with Friday's rate not yet published by cutoff given the standard one-business-day lag [\[43\]](#)[\[44\]](#). VIX9D/VIX6M, MOVE, dealer gamma/GEX and the CBOE put/call ratio remain unobtainable for free and are marked unavailable in Annex A.

6. THE DAY AHEAD

The week bunches several of 2026's biggest scheduled catalysts into five sessions:

Mon 24 Aug	Chicago Fed National Activity Index (Jul); 3&6-month T-bill auctions	Bessent Iran-sanctions press conference expected today
Tue 25 Aug	Conference Board Consumer Confidence (Aug); Richmond Fed Mfg Index	Dick's Sporting Goods Q2 earnings
Wed 26 Aug	Durable Goods (Jul); Q2 GDP 2nd estimate; PCE / core PCE (Jul)	NVDA FQ2 earnings AMC — cons. EPS \$2.09, rev \$92.07bn
Thu 27 Aug	Jackson Hole Symposium opens (through Sat 29)	Marvell Technology earnings AMC — cons. EPS \$0.93
Fri 28 Aug	Fed Chair Kevin Warsh — first Jackson Hole keynote, approx. 10:00am ET	Theme: "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy"

Sector setup we take into the week

- **Materials / Industrials / Autos:** a fresh headwind from the US–Canada tariff escalation, layered onto a week that already made these two of the three weakest S&P sectors.
- **Mega-cap Tech / AI:** Wednesday's NVDA print is the single largest swing factor for the Nasdaq into month-end, with options pricing an approx. 7% move.
- **Rates-sensitive / Financials:** watching whether Fed Chair Warsh's Friday debut validates the market's hold-with-hike-risk pricing or pushes back on it.
- **Crypto-adjacent equities (COIN, MSTR, MARA):** extended and momentum-driven after Friday's breakout — a Bitcoin fade would likely hit these hardest.

ANNEX A — COULD NOT BE VERIFIED

- Boeing's and Advance Auto Parts' Friday-specific follow-through moves (only Thursday's causes were confirmed this edition).
- Coty's Friday follow-through or stabilization.
- Deere's Friday move — no dated source located.
- Robinhood's (HOOD) confirmed Friday closing price — only an unconfirmed approx. +11% intraday read was found.
- Marvell, Teradyne and AppLovin's Friday moves are single-sourced (one intraday recap) and not independently cross-checked.
- A same-day (Friday-only) 11-sector GICS closing table — only a week-ending cut (LPL) was obtainable for free.
- Exchange-confirmed (CME/ICE) settlement prints for WTI, Brent, gold, silver, copper, natural gas or platinum on Fri 21 Aug — all figures used are vendor/press snapshots.
- Eurozone, UK and Germany flash-PMI services/composite breakdowns — sourcing was thin or single-sourced (one AI-aggregator site) and excluded as non-core to the equity-relevant macro scope.
- A confirmed post-deadline (Sat 22 Aug) USD/CAD reaction level.
- Friday's SOFR print — not yet published as of the research cutoff (standard one-business-day lag; posts Monday).
- VIX9D, VIX6M, MOVE index, dealer gamma/GEX and the CBOE daily put/call ratio — persistently unobtainable free, as in prior editions.
- Precise CFTC CoT release timestamp for this specific week (3:30pm ET is the standard schedule, not independently re-confirmed for this release).
- A post-opex (Fri 21 Aug) options-volume or gamma-unwind retrospective — only pre-event framing pieces were found.
- Which side (US or Canada) introduced new terms late in the collapsed trade talks — both governments gave conflicting accounts.

ANNEX B — SOURCES

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- [44] FRED (St. Louis Fed), SOFR series, fred.stlouisfed.org
- [45] RealInvestmentAdvice.com, "OPEX Overload: How \$3 Trillion In Expirations Can Move Markets"
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Method note. All figures are sourced from named, dated third-party reporting or primary releases (Federal Reserve, CFTC, EIA, Polymarket) via web search and page fetches conducted 24 Aug 2026. Every session date was cross-checked against at least one independent source before use; where sources disagreed, the more authoritative or better-corroborated figure was used and the disagreement disclosed inline or in Annex A. No figure was estimated, inferred, or filled from memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex A rather than approximated. "Approx." denotes a vendor/press snapshot rather than an exchange-confirmed settlement. This edition corrects a Fed-Chair/Jackson-Hole-date error present in earlier drafting assumptions; see the box at the top of page 1.